



January 27, 2026

SENATE BILL No. 164

DIGEST OF SB 164 (Updated January 27, 2026 11:29 am - DI 150)

Citations Affected: IC 15-11.

Synopsis: Study of community or urban microfarming. Requires the department of agriculture (department) to conduct a study to evaluate the feasibility of establishing community or urban microfarm zones statewide. Requires the department to submit a report to the general assembly containing certain findings and recommendations not later than December 1, 2027.

Effective: July 1, 2026.

Spencer, Tomes

January 5, 2026, read first time and referred to Committee on Agriculture.
January 27, 2026, amended, reported favorably — Do Pass.

SB 164—LS 6716/DI 148



January 27, 2026

Second Regular Session of the 124th General Assembly (2026)

PRINTING CODE. Amendments: Whenever an existing statute (or a section of the Indiana Constitution) is being amended, the text of the existing provision will appear in this style type, additions will appear in **this style type**, and deletions will appear in ~~this style type~~.

Additions: Whenever a new statutory provision is being enacted (or a new constitutional provision adopted), the text of the new provision will appear in **this style type**. Also, the word **NEW** will appear in that style type in the introductory clause of each SECTION that adds a new provision to the Indiana Code or the Indiana Constitution.

Conflict reconciliation: Text in a statute in *this style type* or ~~this style type~~ reconciles conflicts between statutes enacted by the 2025 Regular Session of the General Assembly.

SENATE BILL No. 164

A BILL FOR AN ACT to amend the Indiana Code concerning agriculture and animals.

Be it enacted by the General Assembly of the State of Indiana:

1 SECTION 1. IC 15-11-2-10 IS ADDED TO THE INDIANA CODE
2 AS A **NEW** SECTION TO READ AS FOLLOWS [EFFECTIVE JULY
3 1, 2026]: **Sec. 10. (a) The department shall conduct a study to**
4 **evaluate the feasibility of establishing community or urban**
5 **microfarm zones statewide.**

6 **(b) The study conducted under subsection (a) must include the**
7 **following:**

8 **(1) A summary of existing studies and literature regarding the**
9 **feasibility of establishing community or urban microfarm**
10 **zones statewide.**

11 **(2) Identification of zoning templates and best practices for**
12 **community or urban microfarm management.**

13 **(3) Opportunities for partnerships with the Purdue University**
14 **cooperative extension service, local health departments,**
15 **health care providers, and educational institutions.**

16 **(c) Not later than December 1, 2027, the department shall**
17 **submit a report to the general assembly, in an electronic format**

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- 1 under IC 5-14-6, with the following information:
- 2 (1) The findings regarding subsection (b)(1) through (b)(3).
- 3 (2) A specific finding as to:
- 4 (A) whether and how community or urban microfarm
- 5 zones could work in Indiana; and
- 6 (B) what options are available for future pilot programs or
- 7 technical assistance.
- 8 (3) A recommendation for:
- 9 (A) standards to ensure safety and compatibility; and
- 10 (B) future legislation to implement community or urban
- 11 microfarm zones.



COMMITTEE REPORT

Mr. President: The Senate Committee on Agriculture, to which was referred Senate Bill No. 164, has had the same under consideration and begs leave to report the same back to the Senate with the recommendation that said bill be AMENDED as follows:

Page 1, delete lines 1 through 17, begin a new paragraph and insert:

"SECTION 1. IC 15-11-2-10 IS ADDED TO THE INDIANA CODE AS A **NEW** SECTION TO READ AS FOLLOWS [EFFECTIVE JULY 1, 2026]: **Sec. 10. (a) The department shall conduct a study to evaluate the feasibility of establishing community or urban microfarm zones statewide.**

(b) The study conducted under subsection (a) must include the following:

(1) A summary of existing studies and literature regarding the feasibility of establishing community or urban microfarm zones statewide.

(2) Identification of zoning templates and best practices for community or urban microfarm management.

(3) Opportunities for partnerships with the Purdue University cooperative extension service, local health departments, health care providers, and educational institutions."

Page 2, delete lines 1 through 5.

Page 2, line 6, delete "July 1, 2027," and insert "**December 1, 2027,**".

Page 2, line 9, delete "(b)(4)." and insert "**(b)(3).**".

and when so amended that said bill do pass.

(Reference is to SB 164 as introduced.)

LEISING, Chairperson

Committee Vote: Yeas 8, Nays 0.

